

it be better if we thought a bit longer-term for our own sake?

Last year we saw people coming up with creative ways to solve newfound problems. Innovations in multiple aspects of work and life flourished. However, most of them were related to, and were in response to the pandemic.

Now, second-degree innovations and further would continue because entrepreneurs are finding, and will find, more good ideas and a conducive environment. Moreover, we also saw what is possible during unprecedented times, which has opened up so many opportunities.

Essentially it has changed or challenged several mental models that were rigid before the pandemic. Hence the leaning toward paradigm-shifting innovations.

Additionally, the good thing is, a large number of consumers are more open and ready to test new products or ideas. Businesses must use this opportunity to innovate and test them; the time could not be more conducive than now.

The new normal will see paradigm-shifting innovations and what is done and how it is done.

More people will prefer products and services that are not reacting to the crisis anymore but taking them toward a new, better life. Businesses need to institutionalise things that worked during the grand experiment last year. It may be the work from anywhere model, investing in next-gen products or services, or new capability building. Whatever worked, build on it quickly and move forward.

Every disruption brings acceleration in certain areas and reduction in a few others, simultaneously. These changes further lead to convergence. Followed by divergence in preferences and ways of life, it finally results in redirection. Acceleration and reduction have happened last year, so now is the time for convergence. Convergence with a new kind of innovation.



Now the six aspects you must focus on

It will be a rhetorical statement to say that we are living in VUCA (volatility, uncertainty, complexity, and ambiguity) time. We already know and acknowledge that. However, it is more important to understand what it takes not only to live but also to succeed and thrive in VUCA.

I want to emphasize six skills and capabilities that might help you take steps toward this VUCA journey and thrive. As the new normal will have higher dependency and conductivity for innovation, it makes sense to see these six aspects from an innovation lens.

1. First principles based thinking. Develop organisation level capability to think on the first principle basis. More the employees that learn this ability, the better your company will get at innovation.

2. Resourcefulness. Every time people do not rely on resources and become resourceful instead, innovation happens. We saw it last year, and we have seen it before. Building this mindset is the key to successful innovation.

3. Organisational agility. Despite having good ideas and resources, it can be a lengthy, or worse, a futile journey without agility. Agility in the VUCA world is a must-have trait for an individual and an organisation.

4. Foresight skills. As I mentioned before, every disruption brings

some roller-coaster experience with it. Whether you decide to ride it, stay out of it, or enjoy it, each of those decisions needs foresight skills. Moreover, foresight skills in the VUCA environment help stay on or ahead of the curve at all times.

5. Experimentation culture. Innovation, by default, needs experimentation to be effective. Building a culture within an organisation is crucial. Without that it is pointless to go on the innovation journey.

6. Speed. Finally, what is the point if you cannot get to the destination in time? Speed in the right direction is of utmost necessity. Progressing in your innovation journey at the right speed can ensure success.

If you focus on these six aspects, thriving in the new normal with paradigm innovation is possible. These skills and capabilities can put your business in a better-prepared state to make the most.

You may not be the fastest, but if you are agile and get up quickly, you will have a greater chance to take the lead.

The point is

When talking about new normal or economy after disruption, predictions are plenty and mostly valid until they are not. The key is to take steps towards renovating and innovating your business. The size of your business, small, medium, or large, would not matter. Consider it to be a race where everyone was knocked off and fell (exceptions apply).

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Now the question to ponder upon is, "Are you willing to embrace new-age innovation and change the game?" **EFY**



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